



March 30, 2026

To Whom It May Concern,

Mr. Dayi Fan is a Ph.D. candidate who will graduate soon, and I am his dissertation advisor. I am pleased to offer my strong support for his selection as a Shadow PC member for VLDB 2027. Dayi is highly qualified to serve in this role for the following reasons:

1. Dayi has tackled several classical and highly challenging graph problems, including Tree Edit Distance (TED), maximum matching via the Blossom algorithm, and the Hungarian algorithm for the assignment problem. He has developed efficient parallel algorithms and implementations on multicore CPUs and GPUs, demonstrating strong intellectual capability and technical expertise.
2. His Ph.D. dissertation is based on five publications in top venues: PVLDB (2024, 2025, 2026), IEEE Transactions on Parallel and Distributed Systems, and SIGMETRICS. Through this work, he has gained a deep understanding of the standards and expectations of leading research venues.
3. Dayi has helped me in reviewing submissions for conferences such as ICDE (2024 and 2025), PPOPP, and SoCC. He consistently demonstrates high-quality judgment, thoroughness, and a strong sense of responsibility, making him a reliable and effective reviewer.

If you have any questions, please feel free to contact me (zhang@cse.ohio-state.edu).

Sincerely,

Xiaodong Zhang, Ph.D.

Distinguished University Scholar and Robert M. Critchfield Professor in Engineering
Department of Computer Science and Engineering